



Ever spotted a ducky with a fancy collar? That's probably a Ring-necked Duck! These ducks are quite the lookers with their glossy black heads and backs, and a chic white ring around their bill. Males are particularly stylish with a purplish-black chest and two white rings on their neck. Females, on the other hand, are more modest with their light brown feathers.

Guess what's for dinner? If you're a Ring-necked Duck, it's a buffet of underwater treats! They are diving ducks and like to eat seeds of pondweeds, wild rice, bulrushes, and sometimes small fish and insects. They're even known to dive as deep as 30 feet to fetch their food. Imagine being able to hold your breath and dive that deep for a snack!

Let's embark on the journey of a Ring-necked Duck's life. After hatching, the ducklings leave the nest within a day and can swim and feed themselves immediately. However, they don't start flying until they're about 50-55 days old. Ring-necked Ducks live mostly in the northern parts of North America and fly south when it starts to get chilly.



Ring-necked Ducks have a quiet life, but they do interact with humans and other animals. People often see them in city parks and they're popular with birdwatchers. They don't have too many enemies, but sometimes have to watch out for eagles, hawks, and raccoons. Did you know that they're actually named for the chestnut-colored ring around their neck, which is hard to see? Now that's a fun fact to share at your next playdate!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What is the color of the chest of male Ring-necked Ducks?
A. Purplish-black B. Tan-Brown C. Yellow-orange D. White-gray
- 2) Which of the following do ring-necked ducks like to eat?
A. Small birds like finches B. Small rodents
C. Nuts and legumes D. seeds of pondweeds
- 3) When do the Ring-necked Ducks start flying?
A. About 50-55 days old B. After a year
C. As soon as they hatch D. About 10 days old
- 4) What color is the ring-necked ducks head?
A. White B. Black C. Gray D. Tan
- 5) For what are Ring-necked Ducks named?
A. The chestnut-colored ring around their neck B. The white ring around their bill
C. The way they build their nests in rings D. Their ability to dive through rings
- 6) What is the color of the feathers of female Ring-necked Ducks?
A. Black B. Green C. Red D. Brown
- 7) Where do Ring-necked Ducks live mostly?
A. Africa B. Antarctica C. Asia D. North America
- 8) How deep can Ring-necked Ducks dive for their food?
A. No more than 1 feet B. Up to 100 feet
C. Only on the surface D. As deep as 30 feet
- 9) What color is the ring around a Ring-necked Duck's bill?
A. Black B. Brown C. White D. Purple
- 10) What can Ring-necked Ducks do after a day of hatching?
A. Build nests B. Fly C. Swim and feed themselves D. Sing

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "When the weather turns chilly, I pack my things and head south. I prefer the warmer climates."
- 12) "My dinner plate includes water plants like seaweed, rice, and bulrushes."
- 13) "Us males are quite stylish with a purplish-black chest and two white rings on the neck."
- 14) "I start flying immediately after hatching."
- 15) "I couldn't start flying until I was almost 2 months old."
- 16) "I mainly eat large fish and mammals."
- 17) "I like to stay in the nest for a few weeks after hatching."
- 18) "I got my name because of the colored ring around my neck."

- 19) "Hawks and raccoons keep me on my toes, but I don't run into too many dangers."
- 20) "I live mostly in the northern parts of North America."
- 21) "I'm called a Ring-necked Duck because of the white ring around my bill."
- 22) "Just one day after hatching, I was ready to swim and feed myself."
- 23) "I cannot swim or feed myself after I hatch."
- 24) "Did you know that I can dive deep down to 30 feet to find my food? That's a long way to go for a snack!"
- 25) "We Ring-necked Ducks don't dive for our food, instead we catch it out of the air."
- 26) "I'm mostly found in the southern parts of North America."
- 27) "Females like me have modest but beautiful light brown feathers."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 28)** Ring-necked Ducklings start flying when they are around 50 days old.
- 29)** The fact that Baby Ring-necked Ducks can swim and feed themselves right after hatching is amazing.
- 30)** Ring-necked Ducks can dive as deep as 30 feet to fetch their food.
- 31)** The way Ring-necked Ducks dive as deep as 30 feet to fetch their food is pretty impressive.
- 32)** Female Ring-necked Ducks have light brown feathers.
- 33)** It is always a pleasure to see Ring-necked Ducks in city parks.
- 34)** Ring-necked Ducks mostly live in the northern parts of North America and migrate south in colder seasons.
- 35)** Ring-necked Ducks are diving ducks that eat seeds of pondweeds, wild rice, bulrushes, and sometimes small fish and insects.
- 36)** Female Ring-necked Ducks, with their light brown feathers, are the prettiest of all ducks.
- 37)** The glossy black heads of Ring-necked Ducks make them look mysterious.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 38) Male and female Ring-necked ducks have different color feathers.
- 39) Ring-necked ducks have a light brown head and back.
- 40) Ring-necked ducks can swim immediately after they hatch.
- 41) All Ring-necked Ducks have two white rings on their neck.
- 42) Male ring-necked ducks have a purple chest.
- 43) Ring-necked Ducks can dive as deep as 400 feet to fetch their food.
- 44) Eagles and ring-necked ducks share nests and raise their young together.
- 45) Ring-necked Duckling can fly as soon as they hatch.
- 46) Ring-necked ducks dive as deep as 30 feet to find food.
- 47) Ring-necked Ducks are found in the northern parts of North America.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 48)** It's easy to spot a ring-necked duck due to its distinctive markings.
A. it was B. it is
C. it has D. it had
- 49)** I've seen a ring-necked duck at the pond near my house.
A. I have B. I was
C. I had D. I am



- 50) Ring-necked ducks don't have actual rings around their necks.
A. does not B. cannot
C. did not D. do not
- 51) Ring-necked ducks can't fly until they're 60 days old.
A. cannot B. can
C. will not D. could not
- 52) They're known for their bold white rings around their bills.
A. they had B. they were
C. they are D. they have

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 53) Ring-necked ducks can migrate long distances.
- 54) Ring-necked ducks are often mistaken for Scaups, isn't that funny!
- 55) It's astonishing that ring-necked ducks prefer deeper, more remote waters!
- 56) It's amazing how the female ring-necked duck builds her nest from aquatic plants!
- 57) These ducks are dive for their food, isn't that fascinating!
- 58) Ring-necked ducks eat aquatic plants, seeds, and insects.
- 59) What is the lifespan of a ring-necked duck?
- 60) The migration of Ring-necked ducks is impressive!
- 61) The female ring-necked duck lays 8-12 eggs.
- 62) Why are ring-necked ducks called "ring-necked"?
- 63) Wow, they have a maximum flight speed of 50 miles per hour!
- 64) What do ring-necked ducks eat?
- 65) Ring-necked ducks are strong and fast fliers, how exciting!
- 66) Wow! The average lifespan of a ring-necked duck in the wild is around 11 years!
- 67) Their name comes from a faint brownish ring around the neck of the male, which is hard to see, such an interesting fact!
- 68) These ducks are often seen plunging their heads underwater in the search for food, what a sight!



Ring-necked Duck

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Ring-necked Duck

Name: _____

1.	A	26.	Not	51.	A
2.	D	27.	Would	52.	C
3.	A	28.	fact	53.	declarative
4.	B	29.	opinion	54.	exclamatory
5.	A	30.	fact	55.	exclamatory
6.	D	31.	opinion	56.	exclamatory
7.	D	32.	fact	57.	exclamatory
8.	D	33.	opinion	58.	declarative
9.	C	34.	fact	59.	interrogative
10.	C	35.	fact	60.	exclamatory
11.	Would	36.	opinion	61.	declarative
12.	Would	37.	opinion	62.	interrogative
13.	Would	38.	true	63.	exclamatory
14.	Not	39.	false	64.	interrogative
15.	Would	40.	true	65.	exclamatory
16.	Not	41.	false	66.	exclamatory
17.	Not	42.	true	67.	exclamatory
18.	Would	43.	false	68.	exclamatory
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Would	45.	false		
21.	Not	46.	true		
22.	Would	47.	true		
23.	Not	48.	B		
24.	Would	49.	A		
25.	Not	50.	D		